

business plan, borrow money, and spend the money to get the business going. Then you go out and try to sell your ideas, services, or products. Of course, this scares people and sounds risky. That's why he teaches people to do the exact opposite: flip the traditional business model on its head just like we do with conventional personal finance wisdom when we *Choose FI*.

The traditional business model ends with the sale. To do the opposite, we start with sales. Donegan stresses that to get an honest opinion, you need to ask people to buy something. Up until that point they will be nice to you. He said, "If you ask for the sale, you'll get the real response. And if you get the sale before you go into debt, you can start your business without risk, because if they say yes, you're going. You've got an order. Your business is running. If they say no, you've lost nothing." There's a common misconception that if you build it, they will come. Donegan emphasizes that if you build it, no one will come until you market it and sell it. Even then, they may not buy. This is why he starts with sales to limit downside risk.

This theme was emphasized by other guests on the *ChooseFI* podcast who took the entrepreneurial path. Dominick Quartuccio, the life coach and author of the book *Design Your Future*, shared his approach with Brad and Jonathan: "When I have a new concept, I